CalWORKs Program Guide: D. Child Care Approval or Denial

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-010: CHILD CARE
TITLE: D. APPROVAL OR DENIAL OF STAGE ONE CHILD CARE

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE
Under CDSS MPP EAS 47-300, County HHSA must promptly determine eligibility and authorize Stage One Child Care assistance for CalWORKs participants who need child care to participate in approved Welfare-to-Work (WTW) activities, education, or unsubsidized employment.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & DECISION TIMEFRAMES
? Timeliness of Approval: The caseworker must approve or deny child care requests within 10 calendar days of receiving completed application forms and provider information.
? 12-Month Continuous Authorization: Once approved, Stage One Child Care must be authorized for a minimum of 12 continuous months without requiring re-verification of income, work hours, or participation, regardless of temporary changes in hours.
? Grounds for Approval: Child care is approved when:
(1) The participant is engaging in an approved WTW activity, job search, education, or employment;
(2) The child is a member of the AU or child-only unit under 13 years of age (or up to 18 if disabled); and
(3) The chosen provider meets all licensing or TrustLine requirements.
? Grounds for Denial: Requests are denied only when the provider fails background clearance, child age exceeds statutory limits, or the parent refuses to participate in an approved activity.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST
? Witten Notice Requirement: Issue an approval or denial Notice of Action (NOA) to both the participant and the child care provider within the 10-day timeframe.
? Payment Certificate: Issue the Child Care Payment Certificate outlining approved hours, monthly authorized reimbursement amounts, and billing submission

instructions.

? Transition to Stage Two: Coordinate transfer to the local Alternative Payment Program (APP) for Stage Two Child Care as the participant approaches 24 months of aid.